

This Month's DVD Contents

This month's DVD is packed with some new, updated and engaging electronic design automation (EDA) tools for design and simulation, along with informative videos and source codes of projects featured in the do-it-yourself section

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Colasoft Capsa Enterprise (version 8.0.0.8053)

Colasoft recently released a new version of Colasoft Capsa Network Analyser, which is a multi-functional tool with varied analyses capabilities like real-time packet capture, network monitoring, in-depth packet decoding and displaying automatic expert diagnosis of that data. Six major tasks that you can accomplish with this tool are network traffic analysis, network communication monitoring, network problems diagnosis, network security analysis, network performance monitoring and network protocol analysis. With the latest developed wireless analysis drivers, Colasoft Capsa 8 Enterprise can capture, monitor and analyse traffic from your wireless networks. It can be from one access point (AP) or multiple APs.

KiCad (version 4.0.0 RC1)

KiCad is an open source, EDA tool for the creation of electronic schematic diagrams and printed circuit board (PCB) artwork. It incorporates an ensemble of standalone software tools that together constitute KiCad. These are Eeschema (editor for both schematic and component), CvPcb (footprint selector), Pcbnew (editor for circuit boards), GerbView (Gerber viewer), Bitmap2Component (converts bitmap images to footprints or components), PCB Calculator (application for determining colour codes, track width, electrical spacing and other parameters) and Pl editor (editor for page layout).

JumboCAD EDA (version 2.0)

JumboCAD EDA is an easy-to-use schematic, PCB layout and simula-

Some popular resources

7-Zip (version 15.07 beta). A file archiver utility application with a high compression ratio to help you extract compressed files and create your own compressed files in several different formats

Apache Open Office (version 4.1.1). An open source office software suite for word processing, spreadsheets, presentations, graphics and databases

ClamWin (version 0.98.7). An open source, free antivirus tool used by more than 600,000 users worldwide for Windows platform

Expert PDF Reader. A free PDF viewer software that lets you view and print PDF documents on Windows operating systems (OSes)

VirtualBox (version 5.0.4). A x86 and AMD64/Intel64 virtualisation product for enterprise as well as home use. You can now run any software tool and legacy application in a virtual environment. VirtualBox runs on Windows, Linux, Macintosh and Solaris hosts, and supports a large number of guest OSes

WinDirStat (version 1.1.2). A disk-usage-statistics viewer and cleanup tool for Windows

Wireshark (version 1.12.6). A network-packet analyser that captures network packets and tries to display that packet data in as much detail as possible

tion tool. It contains three packages, namely, schematic capture, PCB designer and library editor. PCB designer can work up to 16 layers. The library editor contains part editor, symbol editor and footprint editor that allow you to create schematic symbols, PCB footprint and components. Circuit simulation of schematic capture is temporarily disabled by developers. Ngspice, available in July 2015 DVD, can be used as a circuit simulator. Built-in simulation viewer makes direct-current bias, transient and frequency-response analysis easy.

Alliance CAD System (version 5.0)

Alliance CAD System is a free set of EDA tools and portable cell libraries for very-large-scale integration (VLSI) design. It covers the design flow from Very high speed integrated circuit Hardware Description Language (VHDL) up to layout. It includes VHDL simulator, register-transfer level synthesis, place and route, netlist extractor, Design Rule Checking and layout editor.

Xyce (version 6.3)

Xyce Parallel Electronic Simulator is a SPICE-compatible circuit simulator,

developed internally at Sandia National Laboratories. It is not a derivative of SPICE. As a mature platform for large-scale parallel-circuit simulation, Xyce supports standard capabilities available from commercial simulators in addition to a variety of devices and models specific to Sandia's needs. Xyce supports standard analysis methods such as steady-state, transient and small-signal frequency domain. A number of other analysis methods have also been implemented including harmonic balance and model-order reduction methods.

Some other tools

gputils. gputils is a collection of tools for Microchip Programmable Interface Controller (PIC) microcontrollers. It is fully compatible with Microchip's tools and MPASM (an assembler that is a command-line or Windows based PC application).

TimingEditor. This is a tool for graphically drawing and editing timing diagrams. You can draw signals, clocks, buses and different kinds of signals. ●

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